

"10"

written by

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FADE IN:

1 INT. BEDROOM - DAY - 1996

1

MICHAEL (late 70's) grey hair, his body is giving out, his voice is soft and weak, he lays in bed propped up with some pillows. A nasal cannula in his nose.

The HOSPICE NURSE walks into the room followed by CAROLINE (40's) ANGELA (14), RYAN (11) and KATIE (7).

HOSPICE NURSE

Michael, you have some visitors.

Caroline pulls a chair up along side the bed, reaches for his hand and holds it. He smiles at her.

CAROLINE

Hey dad. How are you feeling?

MICHAEL

Oh, I'm alright. Tired.

CAROLINE

Yeah?

(pause)

I've brought the kids with me.

KIDS

Hey grandpa.

MICHAEL

You're all getting big.

Caroline looks around, and notices a box on a shelf.

CAROLINE

Dad.

Pointing to the box on a shelf, she stands and walks to it.

CAROLINE (CONT'D)

What's that? I remember seeing this growing up, but you were always so protective of it.

Michael looks over where she is and his voice comes to life.

MICHAEL

Oh that? Bring that here.

She takes the box over to Michael as he rests his hand on it.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
 Let me tell you about this box.
 (beat)
 Your mother had just passed...

FADE TO:

2 **INT. FUNERAL HOME - AFTERNOON - 1955** 2

MICHAEL now younger (mid 30's), dressed in a black suit, stands next his daughter CAROLINE (5) and the casket of his wife ALISON (30's).

People approach them and pay their condolences, they hug them or shake their hands. They touch Caroline's shoulders or pat her head. Michael is emotionless, the weight of everything still hasn't hit him.

3 **EXT. CITY STREET - NIGHT - 1955** 3

Michael sits in his car at a redlight, lost in thought as the light shifts from red to green. Headlights of the car behind him reflect off the mirror onto his face, he is unphased.

HONK!

Michael snaps out of it, looks in the back seat, Caroline is still asleep. He drives away.

4 **EXT. DRIVEWAY - NIGHT - 1955** 4

Michael pulls into the driveway, Caroline is still asleep in the back seat. He picks her up in his arms, holds her tight and makes his way towards the house.

5 **INT. CAROLINE'S BEDROOM - 1955** 5

Michael pulls the covers up over Caroline, and she slowly wakes up.

CAROLINE
 Daddy?

MICHAEL
 Go to sleep, sweetheart, it's ok.

CAROLINE
 I want mommy.

MICHAEL

I know sweetheart, I do too. Mommy
will always be with us, right?

Caroline nods.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

Yeah, cause remember mommy's an
angel watching over us now.

CAROLINE

Daddy?

MICHAEL

Yeah sweetheart?

CAROLINE

I don't want mommy to be angel, I
want her to come home.

Michael tries to fight back tears and not lose it. He musters
a smile and nods his head.

MICHAEL

Get some sleep baby girl.

He kisses her on the forehead and quickly walks out of the
room and shuts the door behind him. He folds over, losing it.

6 **INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT - 1955**

6

Michael lays in bed awake. The door to his room creaks open
and he looks over, Caroline stands in the doorway.

CAROLINE

Mommy?

MICHAEL

Come here sweetheart.

She climbs up on the bed and cuddles up next to him.

CAROLINE

I miss mommy.

MICHAEL

I know baby.

He turns his head away from her, covers his face and holds
his breath doing his best not to sob and her hear him.

7 **INT. HALLWAY - MORNING - 1955**

7

Michael stares at a family portrait as tears stream down.

MICHAEL

You said forever, you promised me.

(beat)

Now what am I supposed to do?

(beat)

What am I supposed to say?

DOORBELL RINGS, he wipes away the tears and walks to

8 **INT. FRONT DOOR - 1955**

8

Michael opens the door, as FRANK (30's) skirts away to his black sedan. As he reaches his car he looks back at Michael and with a half smile he gives a nod to Michael. Michael looks at him confused, he looks familiar but he doesn't know why.

Michael's attention redirects to the package sitting on the front step at his feet.

9 **INT. LIVING ROOM - 1955**

9

Michael sits on the couch, places the package on the coffee table and opens it.

Inside the package is a wooden box with an envelope on top. He picks up the envelope, opens it, and reads the card.

ALISON (V.O.)

Michael, my love. I wish I could walk through that door, kiss you, and tell you everything will be fine. My heart aches for what you must be feeling. But know that I love you deeply and cherish every moment we had together. I know you are probably thinking: Can I go back and change something? The answer is no. But if you could go back for a moment would you?

(beat)

So this my love is my final, parting gift to you. Forever in my heart, your loving wife.

Michael lays the card on the table and pulls the old wooden box out. He pushes the cardboard box onto the floor and sits the wooden box on the table as he looks it over curiously.